

0.0.1 Nandamata

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time, the venerable Sariputta and the venerable Mahamoggallana were wandering on tour with a large community of bhikkhus. Now on that occasion the female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka, having risen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana.

2. At that time the great king Vessavana, was travelling from northern region to the southern region on some business. The great king, Vessavana heard the female lay disciple, Nandamata chanting the Parayana. Having heard, he stood waiting for the chanting to finish. Then the female lay disciple, Nandamata having chanted the

nandamātu suttaṃ

evamme suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ āyasmā ca sārīputto āyasmā ca mahāmoggallāno dakkhiṇāgirismiṃ cārikaṃ caranti mahatā bhikkhu saṅghena saddhiṃ. tena kho pana samayena velukaṇṭakī nandamātā upāsikā rattiyaṃ paccūsasamayaṃ paccūṭṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhāsati.

tena kho pana samayena vessavaṇo mahārājā uttarāya disāya¹ dakkhiṇaṃ disaṃ gacchati kenacideva karaṇīyena. assosi kho vessavaṇo mahārājā nandamātāya upāsikāya pārāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhāsantiyā. sutvā

¹uttaradisāya - sīmu. ■

Parayana, became silent.

kathāpariyosānaṃ
āgamayamāno aṭ-
ṭhāsi. atha kho nan-
damātā upāsikā pā-
rāyaṇaṃ sareṇa bhā-
sitvā tuṇhī ahoṣi.

3. So then the great king Vessavana having known that the female disciple, Nandamata had finished, greatly rejoiced saying: “Good sister, good sister.”

atha kho vessavaṇo
mahārājā nandamā-
tāya upāsikāya ka-
thāpariyosānaṃ vi-
ditvā abbhānumodi:
sādhū bhagini, sā-
dhu bhaginīti.

4. “But who is this dear?”

ko panaṇesa bhadra-
mukhāti.

5. “I, O sister, am your brother, the great king Vessavana.”

ahaṃ te bhaginī bhātā
vessavaṇo mahārā-
jāti.

6. Good dear. Well now, may this dhamma discourse chanted by me be my gift to you as my guest.

sādhū bhadramu-
kha, tena hi yo me
ayaṃ dhammapari-
yāyo bhaṇito, idante
hotu ātittheyanti.

7. Very well sister, may

sādhū bhaginī, etaṃ

this also be your gift to me as your guest. Tomorrow the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana will come to Velukantaka without having eaten their morning meal. Having served that community of bhikkhus, dedicate the offering to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

8. Then with the passing of the night, the female lay disciple, Nandamata prepared excellent hard foods and soft foods at her own house. Then the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana, without having eaten their morning meal, arrived at Velukantaka.

9. So then the female lay disciple, Nandamata addressed a certain man: “Come you good man, having gone

ceva me hotu āti-theyyaṃ: sve ca sārīputta moggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso veḷukaṇṭakaṃ āgamiṣṣati. tañca bhikkhusaṅghaṃ parivisittvā mama dakkhiṇaṃ ādisēyyāsi. evañca me bhaviṣṣati ātithēyyanti.

atha kho nandamātā upāsikā tassā rattiyaṃ accayena sake nivesane paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpesi. atha kho sārīputtamoggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso yena veḷukaṇṭako tadavasārī.

atha kho nandamātā upāsikā aññataraṃ purisaṃ āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ ambho purisa, ārāmaṃ gantvā

to the monastery, announce to the community of bhikkhus: “It is time Bhante, the meal is ready at the house of the noble lady, Nandamata.””

bhikkhusaṅghassa
kālaṃ ārocehi: "kālo
bhante, ayyāya nan-
damātuyā nivesane
niṭṭhitam bhatta, nti.
evaṃ ayye, ti kho so
puriso nandamātāya
upāsikāya paṭissu-
tvā ārāmaṃ gantvā
bhikkhusaṅghassa
kālaṃ ārocesi: "kālo
bhante, ayyāya nan-
damātuyā nivesane
niṭṭhitam bhattanti,
"

10. Then in the morning, the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallāna, having dressed, having taken bowl and robe, went to the female lay disciple, Nandamata's house. Upon arrival, they sat down on a prepared seat.

atha kho sārīputta-
moggallānapamukho
bhikkhusaṅgho pub-
banhasamayam nivā-
setvā pattacīvaram
ādāya yena nanda-
mātuyā upāsikāya
nivesanam tenupa-
saṅkami. upasaṅka-
mitvā paṭṭattāsane
nisīdi.

11. So then the female lay

atha kho nandamātā
upāsikā sārīputta-

disciple, Nandamata, with her own hands, served and satisfied the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana with excellent hard foods and soft foods. Then, when the venerable Sariputta had eaten and removed his hand from the bowl, the female lay disciple, Nandamata, having taken a certain lower seat, sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Sariputta said this to the female lay disciple, Nandamata.

12. “But who, O Nandamata, announced to you of the community of bhikkhus arrival?”

13. Here I, O Bhante, having arisen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana. Then, O Bhante, the great king Vessavana having known that I had fin-

moggallānapamu-khaṃ bhikkhusaṅghaṃ paṇītena khādanīyena bhojanīyena sahatvā santappesi sampavāresi. atha kho nandamātā upāsikā āyasmantaṃ sārīputtaṃ bhuttāviṃ onītapattapāṇiṃ ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho nandamātaraṃ upāsikaṃ āyasmā sārīputto etadavoca:

ko pana te nandamāte, bhikkhusaṅghassa abbhāgamaṇaṃ ārocesīti.

idhāhaṃ bhante, rattiyaṃ paccusasamaṃ paccuṭṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sarena bhāsītva tuṇhī ahosiṃ. atha kho bhante, vessavaṇo mahārājā

ished, greatly rejoiced saying:
“Good sister, good sister.”

mama kathāpariyo-
sānaṃ viditvā abbha-
numodi "sādhū bha-
ginī, sādhū bhaginī,
ti.

14. “But who is this dear?”

ko panesa bhadra-
mukhāti.

15. “I, O sister, am your
brother, the great king Vessa-
vana.”

ahaṃ te bhaginī bhātā
vessavaṇo mahārā-
jāti.

16. Good dear. Well now,
may this dhamma discourse
chanted by me be my gift to
you as my guest.

sādhū bhadramu-
kha, tena hi yo me
ayaṃ dhammapari-
yāyo bhaṇito, idante
hotu ātittheyyanti.

17. Very well sister, may
this also be your gift to me
as your guest. Tomorrow
the community of bhikkhus
headed by Sariputta and Mog-
gallāna will come to Velukan-
taka without having eaten
their morning meal. Having
served that community of
bhikkhus, dedicate the offer-

sādhū bhaginī, etaṃ
ceva me hotu āti-
theyyaṃ: sve ca sā-
riputta moggallāna-
pamukho bhikkhu-
saṅgho akatapāta-
rāso velukaṇṭakaṃ
āgamissati. tañca
bhikkhusaṅghaṃ pa-
rivotvā mama dak-

ing to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

18. That is to say, O Bhante, “May the merits of this offering indeed be for the happiness of that great king Vessavana.”

19. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you converse face to face with the great king by the name of Vessavana, the son of the devas who is so powerful, of such great influence.”

20. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

khinam ādiseyyāsi.
evañca me bhavis-
sati ātittheyanti.

yadidaṃ bhante, dāne
puññaṃ hi taṃ² ves-
savaṇassa mahārā-
jassa sukhāya hotuti.

acchariyaṃ nanda-
māte, abbhūtaṃ nan-
damāte, yatra hi nāma
vessavaṇena mahā-
rājena evaṃ mahid-
dhikena evaṃ ma-
hesakkhena deva-
puttena sammukhā
sallapissatīti.

na kho me bhante
esova³ acchariyo ab-
bhuto dhammo. at-
thi me aññopi accha-
riyo abbhuto dhammo:

²puññaṃ puññaṃmahitī - ma-
chasam, puññaṃmaham - pts;
puññaṃmahitaṃ - syā

³eseva - machasam

21. Here, O Bhante, my only son named Nanda, dearly and beloved, the king having seized him on some pretext or another, dragged him away and killed him. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind when the young boy was seized or while being seized; when he was bounded or while being bounded; when he was slain or while being slain.

22. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

23. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

idha me bhante nando nāma⁴ eko puttako piyo manāpo. taṃ rājāno kismiñcideva pakaraṇe okkassa paggayha jīvitā voro-pesum. tasmim kho panāhaṃ bhante, dā-rake gahite vā gay-hamāne vā baddhe vā vajjhamāne vā hate vā haṭṭhamāne vā nābhijānāmi cit-tassa aññathattanti.

acchariyaṃ nanda-māte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

na kho me bhante esova⁵ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

⁴nandako nāma - simu ■

⁵eseva - machasam ■

24. Here, O Bhante, when my husband passed away, he arose in a certain womb of a yakkha. He revealed himself to me with just his former self-begotten. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind on account of that.

idha me bhante, sāmiko kālakato assa aññataraṃ yakkha-
yonim upapanno⁶. so me teneva purimena
attabhāvena uddas-
seti. na kho panā-
haṃ bhante, abhijā-
nāmi tato nidānaṃ
cittassa aññathat-
tanti.

25. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

acchariyaṃ nanda-
māte, abbhūtaṃ nan-
damāte, yatra hi nāma
cittuppādampi pari-
sodhessatīti.

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

na kho me bhante
esova⁷ acchariyo ab-
bhuto dhammo. at-
thi me aññopi accha-
riyo abbhuto dhammo:

27. “From the time, O Bhante, that I was brought to my young husband as a young girl, I do not recall trans-

yato haṃ bhante, sā-

⁶yakkhayoniyam uppanno -
simu ■

⁷eseva - machasaṃ ■

gressing against my husband even in thought, let alone in body.”

28. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

30. “Since I, O Bhante, declared myself a female lay disciple, I do not recall purposely transgressing any training rules.”

31. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented,

mikassa daharas-seva daharā ānītā, nābhijānāmi sāmikam manasāpi aticaritā, kuto pana kāyenāti.

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

na kho me bhante esova⁸ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

yadāhaṃ bhante, upāsikā paṭidesitā, nābhijānāmi kiñci sikkhāpadaṃ sañcicca vītikkamitāti.

acchariyaṃ nanda-

⁸eseva - machasam

O Nandamata.”

32. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

33. Here O Bhante, to whatever extent I wish, quite secluded from sense-desires, secluded from unwholesome dhammas, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of seclusion, connected with thinking and pondering, the first jhana. From the subsiding of thinking and pondering, with the internal tranquilization and unification of mind, without thinking and pondering, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of samadhi, the second jhana. With the fading away of happiness, I, dwelling mindful

māte, abbhutaṃ nandamātetī.

na kho me bhante esova⁹ accharīyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi accharīyo abbhuto dhammo:

idhāhaṃ bhante, yāvadeva¹⁰ ākaṅkhāmi vivicceva kāmehi vivicca akusalehi dhammehi savitakkaṃ savicāraṃ vicekajjaṃ pītisukhaṃ paṭhamam jhānam upasampajja viharāmi. vitakkavicārānaṃ vūpasamā ajjhataṃ sampasādanaṃ cetaso ekodibhāvaṃ avitakkaṃ avicāraṃ samādhijam¹¹ pītisu-

⁹eseva - machasaṃ

¹⁰yāvade - machasaṃ

¹¹vivekajjaṃ machasaṃ

and contemplative, look on with equanimity as I experience pleasure in the body, of which the Noble Ones say:

“The equanimous dweller in pleasure is the mindful one,” I enter upon and abide in the third jhana. From the abandoning of [physical] pleasure and pain, from the extinction of former mental pleasure and mental pain, I enter upon and abide in the utter purity of mindfulness and equanimity, without pain, without pleasure, the fourth jhana.

34. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

35. That is not, O Bhante,

khaṃ dutiyaṃ jhānaṃ upasampajja viharāmi. pītiyā ca virāgā upekkhakā ca viharāmi, satā ca sampajānā sukhāñca kāyena paṭisaṃvedemi. yaṃ taṃ ariyā ācikkhanti upekkhako satimā sukhavihāriti tatiyaṃ jhanaṃ upasampajja viharāmi. sukhassa ca pahānā dukkhassa ca pahānā pubbeva somanassadomanas-sānaṃ atthagamā adukkhaṃ asukhaṃ upekkhāsatipārisuddhiṃ catutthaṃ jhānaṃ upasampajja viharāmi.

acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamātetī.

na kho me bhante

the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

36. Of these five lower fetters declared by the Auspicious One, O Bhante, I do not see any of them that are not abandoned in myself.

37. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

38. Then the venerable Sariputta having further instructed, aroused, energized and gladdened the female lay disciple, Nandamata with talk on the Dhamma, having risen up from his seat, he departed.

esova¹² acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me añño pi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

yānīmāni bhante, bhagavatā desitāni pañcorambhāgiyāni saññojanāni, nāhaṃ tesaṃ kiñci attani appahīnaṃ samanupassāmi.

acchariyaṃ nanda-māte, abbhutaṃ nandamāteti.

atha kho āyasmā sāriputto nandamātaraṃ upāsikaṃ dhammiyā kathāya sandassetvā samādapetvā samuttejetvā sampahaṃsetvā uṭṭhāyāsanā pakkāmiti.

¹²eseva - machasaṃ ■

